1. The "Infamous Eight" Corporate Sponsors

Each campaign begins with selecting a Corporate Sponsor. In the lore, these are the only entities wealthy enough to bypass "The Treaty of Earth" and launch illegal "Protocol 0" colonization efforts.

- **A-Maze Logistics** (Amazon Parallel):
  - **The Prime Protocol**: Grants +2 Inventory slots per scout and +15% Factory processing speed.
  - **Lore**: Their motto is "Everything, Everywhere, Instantly." They view the planet as one giant warehouse. Their scouts are often "Fulfillment Liquidators" sent to clear space for more conveyor belts.
- **G-Verse Analytics** (Google Parallel):
  - **The Search Protocol**: Survey Office starts at Level 2 and reveals all chunk hazards (spore clouds, nests) immediately.
  - **Lore**: Knowledge is the only resource that matters. They don't want to live on the planet; they want to map it, index it, and sell the data back to Earth.
- **Aegis-Global Security** (Blackwater/PMC Parallel):
  - **The Peacekeeper Protocol**: Scouts start with +5 Precision and a -20% cost reduction for all combat-related fabrication.
  - **Lore**: A private military group hired by the other seven to provide "security," only to launch their own colony. They view botanical life as a training exercise.
- **United Terran Administration** (Government Parallel):
  - **The Bureaucracy Protocol**: The Landing Pad holds +2 recruits and Colony Buildings cost 10% less raw materials.
  - **Lore**: The remnants of Earth's dying governments. They are slow, paper-heavy, and desperate to prove they are still in charge.
- **X-Ether Motors** (Tesla/Musk Parallel):
  - **The Disruptor Protocol**: -15% Supply (Oxygen/Energy) drain and +10 Ingenuity stat for all scouts.
  - **Lore**: Run by a CEO who believes the planet is a "design flaw" he can fix. Their gear is sleek, white, and prone to "beta-testing" in the middle of a fight.
- **Aqua-Pure Corp** (Nestlé Parallel):
  - **The Extraction Protocol**: +20% Biological resource yield; Rations grant a temporary "Stamina" (speed) buff.
  - **Lore**: They claim the planet's water and sap are their intellectual property. Their scouts are "Hydration Technicians" tasked with draining the biomes dry.
- **Coke-Zero Defense** (Coca-Cola Parallel):
  - **The Refresh Protocol**: Rec Room recovery is 25% faster and Medical Bay costs are reduced by 15%.
  - **Lore**: Known for "Aggressive Morale Management." They believe a happy scout is a productive scout, even if that happiness is chemically induced.
- **Magic-Hearth Entertainment** (Disney Parallel):
  - **The IP Protocol**: Legacy Points generate 50% faster and Memorial Hall buffs are doubled.
  - **Lore**: They are filming the entire colonization for a "True-Life Frontier" streaming series. They care less about survival and more about "compelling character arcs" and "heroic sacrifices."

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2. The Scouts: Debt-Bonded Contractors

Scouts are the emotional core of the game. They are not volunteers; they are people who owe a debt that can only be paid in "Frontier Credit."

- **Modular Backstory Examples**:
  - **The Failed Influencer**: Owed millions in "G-Verse Privacy Fines." They are charismatic (High Resolve) but fragile (Low Endurance).
  - **The Disgraced Architect**: Their megacity collapsed on Earth. Now they are here to design "A-Maze" silos in the mud. They have High Ingenuity.
  - **The Overworked Coder**: Sent as "Manual QA" after a software bug cost their company billions. They are great with Ancient Constructs but have low Morale.
- **Psychological Relationships**:
  - **Bonds**: If two scouts survive a "Near-Death Event" (e.g., escaping a Vine-Wolf with 5% HP), they form a "Lifeline Bond," giving them a combat bonus when standing in the same chunk.
  - **Rivalries**: Scouts from competing backgrounds (e.g., an Aegis Solider and a G-Verse Coder) may develop "Efficiency Friction," increasing Stress but also increasing XP gain.

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3. Botanical Horror: The Planet's Immune System

The planet is a singular super-organism that views the colony as a virus.

- **The "Push Back" Mechanics**:
  - **Rapid Reclaimers**: If a chunk is not revisited within 3 expeditions, it loses its "Surveyed" status as the jungle literally swallows the paths you cut.
  - **Antibody Species**:
    - **Vine-Wolves**: Predators that use photosynthesis to stay invisible in the brush. They don't eat scouts; they use them as fertilizer for their young.
    - **Spore-Sentinels**: Fungal growths that have "hacked" the nervous systems of Ancient Constructs, turning old robots into organic-metal hybrids.
- **The Ancient Ruins (Corporate Fossils)**:
  - These are the ruins of the "First Wave"—a colonization attempt 30 years ago by the same Eight Corporations.
  - Finding an "Artifact" might just be finding a 30-year-old employee ID badge, revealing that your current boss was the one who abandoned the last crew.

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4. Meta-Narrative: The "Lazarus" Protocol

The true reason for the mission:

- The corporations aren't here for gold; they are here for the planet's **Regenerative Sap**.

- This sap can theoretically grant immortality. The "Colony Ship" landing is the final phase of "harvesting" the planet's heart.
- The **Planetary Threat** escalates as the planet realizes you aren't just visiting—you are trying to kill it for its blood.

character core stats

Stat	Name	Represents...	Gameplay Impact
END	**Endurance**	Physical stamina and lung capacity.	Determines how long they can sprint and how much **Oxygen** they consume.
PRC	**Precision**	Hand-eye coordination and focus.	Accuracy with ranged weapons and success rate of "Delicate" harvesting.
ING	**Ingenuity**	Technical knowledge and problem-solving.	Speed of repairing **Ancient Constructs** and hacking corporate locks.
AWR	**Awareness**	Senses and reaction time.	Increases the **Reveal Radius** (Fog of War) and detection of hidden traps.
RES	**Resolve**	Mental fortitude and "Cool."	High Resolve slows down **Stress** gain and prevents "Mental Snaps."
STR	**Strength**	Raw physical power.	Determines **Inventory Weight Limit** and melee damage.

the Core Stats:

- **HP (Health):** Calculated from **Endurance** and **Strength**.
- **Stress Bar:** The "Sanity" meter. Max capacity is determined by **Resolve**.
- **Stamina/Oxygen:** A combined bar for "Exertion." Determined by **Endurance**.

a scale of **1–20** for starting recruits, with **Veteran** caps at **50**.

- **Low (1–10):** A liability. They need a "Natural Leader" nearby to survive.
- **Average (11–20):** Most "Debt-Bonded" recruits.
- **Elite (21–40):** Veterans with multiple successful runs.
- **Legendary (41–50+):** Legacy Children or scouts with specific "God Roll" trait synergies.

#	Background	Narrative Hook	Mechanical Lean
1	**Overworked Coder**	Sent as manual QA after a bug cost G-Verse billions.	High **Ingenuity**; Low **Resolve**.
2	**Disgraced Architect**	Their megacity collapsed; harvesting for the A-Maze rebuild.	High **Colony Building Speed**.
3	**Failed Influencer**	Owed millions in fines for filming in restricted Magic-Hearth zones.	High **Morale** impact; Low **Endurance**.
4	**Bio-Tech Dropout**	Couldn't pay for their "Surgical License Subscription" to Aqua-Pure.	High **Medical** efficiency.
5	**Junior Liquidator**	A blue-collar worker specialized in "clearing" corporate assets.	High **Precision**.

6	**Warehouse Runner**	Used to high-speed logistics in zero-G A-Maze facilities.	High **Movement Speed**.
7	**Actuarial Drone**	Calculated the "acceptable loss" of the First Wave; now part of it.	High **Awareness**; Low **Precision**.
8	**Hydro-Technicia n**	Drained local Earth lakes for Aqua-Pure; here to find more.	Bonus to **Water/Bio-harvesting**.
9	**Sub-Level Janitor**	Saw something they shouldn't have in an Aegis-Global lab.	High **Stealth/Evasion**.
10	**Corporate Chaplain**	Provided "spiritual wellness" to Coke-Zero factory workers.	High **Resolve**; Buffs party **Morale**.
11	**Patent Lawyer**	Here to serve "cease and desist" orders to the planet's DNA.	High **Ingenuity**; Bonus to **Research Data**.
12	**Luxury Concierge**	Used to handling the whims of the 1%; now handles thorns.	High **Diplomacy/Faction Trade**.
13	**Barista-Grade Chemist**	Made "performance-enhancing" lattes for X-Ether executives.	High **Ration/Stamina** efficiency.

14	**Defaulted Heir**	Their family estate was seized by the United Terran Admin.	High **Starting XP**; Low **Endurance**.
15	**Urban Forager**	Lived in the "Trash-Heaps" of the G-Verse server farms.	High **Scavenging** yield.
16	**Sensory Tuner**	Adjusted the "empathy levels" for Magic-Hearth VR sims.	High **Awareness**.
17	**Industrial Welder**	Built the hulls of the colony ships; knows where they break.	Bonus to **Ancient Construct** repair.
18	**Debt-Collector**	Used to be the one hunting scouts; now they are one.	High **Precision**; Low **Resolve**.
19	**Night-Shift Guard**	Spent ten years watching a static screen for Aegis-Global.	High **Night-Vision/Awareness**.
20	**Soil Analyst**	Trying to find a way to make Coke-Zero crops grow in alien dirt.	High **Survey/Map Data** yield.
21	**Crash-Test Pilot**	X-Ether's favorite "disposable" asset for atmospheric entry.	High **Evasion**; Starts with **Injuries**.

22	**Marketing Intern**	Volunteered to "rebrand" the planet's hostile predators.	High **Morale**; Low **Ingenuity**.
23	**Deep-Sea Miner**	Transferred from Earth's trenches to the planet's wetlands.	High **Endurance**; Wetland movement buff.
24	**History Curator**	Trying to recover "Physical Artifacts" for Magic-Hearth's museum.	High **Legacy Point** generation.
25	**Infrastructure Auditor**	Investigating why the First Wave's buildings are failing.	Bonus to **Ruins Exploration**.
26	**Traffic Controller**	Managed the drone-swarms over A-Maze's capital cities.	Bonus to **Drone/Tech use**.
27	**Gig-Worker**	Has 15 different certifications, none of them at Master level.	Balanced stats; No weaknesses.
28	**Exiled Reporter**	Wrote a "hit piece" on X-Ether; offered a one-way scouting trip.	High **Awareness**; High **Stress** gain.
29	**Lab Assistant**	"Accidentally" inhaled a prototype Aqua-Pure stimulant.	High **Stamina**; Random **Stat Spikes**.

30	**Hobbyist Botanist**	The only person who actually *wants* to be here to see the plants.	High **Flora-Reading** abilities.

Female names

Western/Anglo	**Eastern/Asian**	**Middle Eastern/African**	**Latine/Mediterranean**
Sloane	Ji-Hae	Zahra	Valentina
Elora	Mei	Muna	Chiara
Beatrix	Hana	Fatima	Alessia
Tamsin	Xiu	Inaya	Ximena
Saffron	Tanaka	Amina	Beatriz
Ingrid	Sun-Hi	Jallow	Elena
Saskia	Lin	Okafor	Lucia
Juno	Akiko	Belkacem	Martina
Rhea	Chien	Mariam	Paloma

Lyra	Kanya	Zuri	Estela

Male names

Western/Anglo	**Eastern/Asian**	**Middle Eastern/African**	**Latine/Mediterranean**
Silas	Kenji	Malik	Mateo
Gideon	Wei	Hassan	Santiago
Barrett	Hiroshi	Tariq	Javi
Kael	Bao	Emeka	Rafael
Otis	Sato	Zayn	Dante
Lars	Nguyen	Kwame	Hugo
Finnian	Chen	Omer	Roman
Arthur	Ito	Mustafa	Victor
Cillian	Ryu	Khalid	Marco

Alistair	Myung	Idris	Thiago

Surnames global

Corporate/Western	Asian	African/Middle Eastern	Latine/Euro
Vance	Park	Al-Farsi	Hernandez
Sterling	Zhang	Mansour	Silva
Thorne	Sato	Diop	Rossi
Huxley	Ling	Abdi	Conti
Vane	Tanaka	Nwosu	Reyes
Moss	Nguyen	Khan	Ortiz
Caldwell	Gupta	Jallow	Gonsalves
Sterling	Ito	Aziz	Santos
Faulkner	Kulkarni	Belkacem	Costa

Grier	Myung	Mustafa	Sokolov

If each scout can have **up to 2 traits**, pulled from either the **Positive** or **Double-Edged** pools (15 traits each, 30 total), the combinations of "Trait Profiles" alone (ignoring Gender/History/Sponsor) would be:

- **Total Trait Slots:** 2
- **Total Trait Options:** 30
- **Calculation:** $30 \times 30 = 900$ unique "Trait Identities."

When you combine those **900** trait profiles with the **8** Sponsors and **30** Histories, the mechanical variety jumps to **216,000 distinct character archetypes**.

The "Trait Synergy" Archetypes

Because we are mixing Positive and Double-Edged traits, players will encounter four distinct "Tiers" of scouts at the Landing Pad:

1. The "Golden Child" (Positive + Positive)

- *Example:* **Steady Hand** (+Precision) + **Natural Leader** (-Stress for squad).
- *Vibe:* The reliable hero. Everyone wants them on the team.
- *Player Feeling:* "If I lose this scout, the run is over."

2. The "Specialist" (Positive + Double-Edged)

- *Example:* **Botany Savant** (Safe harvesting) + **Paranoid** (High detection / High stress).
- *Vibe:* A pro who knows their stuff but is a nightmare to work with.
- *Player Feeling:* "I need them to find the resources, but I have to babysit their stress levels."

3. The "Wildcard" (Double-Edged + Double-Edged)

- *Example:* **Hoarder** (+Carry capacity / -Rations) + **Adrenaline Junkie** (+Damage at low HP / Triggers traps).
- *Vibe:* A chaotic mess of a human being who is surprisingly effective in a crisis.
- *Player Feeling:* "This scout is going to get us killed, or save us all. Let's send them in first."

4. The "Plain Joe" (Single Trait)

- *Example:* Just **Efficient** (Better stacking).

- *Vibe:* The reliable baseline.
- *Player Feeling:* "Safe. Not exciting, but low risk."

Positive traits

#	Trait Name	Effect	Tactical Value
1	**Natural Leader**	Reduces Stress gain for the entire squad by 10%.	Keeps the team in the field longer.
2	**Botany Savant**	Can harvest "Hazardous" plants without taking damage.	Safe gathering of high-tier bio-materials.
3	**Efficient**	Personal inventory stacks items (Ammo/Rations) 50% higher.	Allows for deeper, longer expeditions.
4	**Steady Hand**	+15% Precision when Stamina is low.	Clutched shots during exhausted retreats.
5	**Thrill-Seeker**	Temporary Speed boost after entering an unexplored Chunk.	Excellent for rapid scouting/mapping.
6	**Eagle Eye**	Increases fog-of-war reveal radius by 25%.	See predators before they see you.

7	**Iron Stomach**	Can consume raw botanical samples for HP without sickness.	Emergency healing when Rations run dry.
8	**Light Footed**	50% reduced chance to trigger hidden "Plant-Traps."	Safely navigate dense, overgrown areas.
9	**Field Medic**	30% faster revive speed for downed teammates.	Critical for surviving "Apex Predator" ambushes.
10	**Night Owl**	No Precision or Movement penalty in dark/Cave biomes.	Specialized for underground resource runs.
11	**Green Thumb**	10% chance to double the yield of any harvested Flora.	Accelerates Colony growth and research.
12	**Mechanical Soul**	Ancient Constructs are 25% less likely to be hostile.	Easier access to high-tech ruins.
13	**Sturdy**	Gains +20 Max HP; higher resistance to "Vine-Lash" injuries.	The ideal "Tank" for the front of the line.
14	**Optimist**	Small chance to heal a chunk of Stress after a successful kill.	High mental endurance in combat.
15	**Scrounger**	Finds 15% more "Scrap" in non-resource containers (crates/trash).	Great for "Trash-to-Tech" economy runs.

Double edged traits

#	Trait Name	The Pro (Benefit)	The Con (Drawback)
1	**Paranoid**	Detection range for hidden predators is doubled.	Gains Stress 20% faster; hates being the "tail."
2	**Hoarder**	Can carry +1 Heavy Item (Ancient Scrap) easily.	Consumes 2x Rations; refuses to drop loot.
3	**Adrenaline Junkie**	+25% Damage when HP is below 30%.	10% chance to "Auto-trigger" interactables/traps.
4	**Corporate Loyalist**	15% discount on gear from their specific Sponsor.	Takes Stress when using gear from rival Corpos.
5	**Deep Sleeper**	Heals 30% more HP and Stress during Rest/Camp.	Takes 3x longer to "deploy" if camp is ambushed.
6	**Obsessive**	20% faster scanning of specific resource nodes.	Refuses to leave Chunk until 100% surveyed.

7	**Heavy-Handed**	+20% Melee damage; breaks wooden barriers.	10% chance to "break" delicate loot (electronics).
8	**Chatterbox**	Keeps squad Morale high (+10% Resolve).	Noise level is higher; attracts predators easier.
9	**Sucker for Beauty**	Massive Morale boost in "Bioluminescent" biomes.	Easily distracted; -15% Precision in colorful areas.
10	**Claustrophobic**	+15% Speed in wide, open field areas.	Gains Stress rapidly in Caves/Ruins Chunks.
11	**Technophobe**	+15% Endurance (Oxygen/Stamina).	Stress spikes when using Drones or Tech-gadgets.
12	**Glutton**	Rations provide 50% more healing.	Automatically eats a Ration every time they take damage.
13	**Martyr**	Provides Morale buff to squad *if* they take damage.	Gains Stress when the team stays safe for too long.
14	**Clumsy**	Finds 20% more loot (by "stumbling" into it).	5% chance to trip and alert nearby enemies.
15	**Spore-Addict**	Immune to "Spore-Lung" cough disability.	Gains Stress unless they are in "Toxic" plant zones.

Clash table

Trait A	Clashes With	The "Friction" Effect	Narrative Vibe
Chatterbox	**Night Owl**	The Night Owl's stealth bonus is negated; Chatterbox gains Stress from being "shushed."	"Can you just shut up for five seconds? I'm trying to listen for predators."
Obsessive	**Thrill-Seeker**	The Thrill-Seeker loses their speed buff if the Obsessive forces the team to stay in a chunk.	"We've been in this swamp for an hour. There's nothing left but mud!"
Corporate Loyalist	**Scrounger**	The Loyalist refuses to use "dirty" scrap found by the Scrounger, increasing gear repair costs.	"I'm not putting that rusted junk in my Aegis-branded rifle."
Technophobe	**Mechanical Soul**	Mechanical Soul’s "tamed" constructs are 50% more likely to glitch and turn hostile.	"I told you we shouldn't trust the toaster with a pulse!"
Glutton	**Efficient**	The Efficient scout gains Stress every time the Glutton "wastes" a ration.	"That was three days of supplies you just inhaled for a scratch."
Paranoid	**Optimist**	The Optimist’s Morale-on-kill buff is halved; the Paranoid scout thinks the kill "was too easy."	"Don't celebrate. The big one is probably right behind us."

Clumsy	**Light Footed**	Clumsy scouts have a 50% chance to trigger a trap even if the Light Footed scout "disarmed" it.	"Watch your step! No—not there! *Snap.*"
Sucker for Beauty	**Heavy-Handed**	Every time the Heavy-Handed scout breaks a barrier, the Beauty-lover loses Morale.	"You just smashed a 200-year-old crystal bloom for a shortcut..."
Martyr	**Field Medic**	Martyr gains Stress when the Medic heals them; the Medic takes longer to revive the Martyr.	"I don't need your help! My sacrifice was supposed to mean something!"
Claustrophobic	**Deep Sleeper**	If camping in a Cave, the Claustrophobic scout keeps the Deep Sleeper awake (negating rest).	"I can feel the ceiling getting lower. How can you sleep right now?!"

injury table

#	Injury Name	Type	The Penalty (The Horror)	The Benefit (The Evolution)
1	**Spore-Lung**	Treatable	Periodic coughing pings the map for enemies.	Coughing releases a cloud that obscures enemy vision.
2	**Chlorophyll-Veins**	**Scar**	-15 Max HP (Blood is thinning).	Heals 2 HP every 10s while in direct light.
3	**Vine-Lash Scars**	**Scar**	+20% Stress gain in Jungle Chunks.	Hardened skin grants +10% Melee Damage.
4	**Sap-Burn**	Treatable	-10% Precision (Hand tremors).	Melee attacks apply a "Slow" debuff to enemies.
5	**Fungal Blight**	Treatable	Consumes 25% more Oxygen/Supplies.	Leaves a trail of spores that buffs squad speed by 10%.

6	**Thorny Calluses**	**Scar**	Cannot equip "Glove" or "Fine-Tool" items.	Unarmed attacks deal high Bleed damage.
7	**Mycelium Link**	**Scar**	-20% Resolve (Planet "whispers").	Can "sense" resource nodes through walls (7m).
8	**Photosynthetic**	**Scar**	Hunger (Rations) drains 2x faster.	Stamina regenerates 50% faster in daylight.
9	**Parasitic Bloom**	Treatable	Morale is capped at 70%.	On death, releases a massive stun-spore explosion.
10	**Wooden Limb**	**Scar**	-15% Movement Speed.	Immune to "Bleed" and "Limb-Crippling" status effects.
11	**Biolum-Eyes**	**Scar**	30% Precision penalty in bright daylight.	Perfect night vision; 100% Precision in Caves.
12	**Pollen-Fever**	Treatable	Randomly "sneezes," alerting nearby enemies.	High resistance to all other toxic/gas hazards.

13	**Tangle-Foot**	**Scar**	10% chance to "Root" in place when hit.	Immune to knockback; +20% Weight Carry capacity.
14	**Petrified Skin**	**Scar**	Inventory slots reduced by 2 (Less flexible).	+2 Armor (Flat damage reduction).
15	**Seeding Wound**	Treatable	Takes 1 damage every 50 steps moved.	Drops "Bio-Seeds" that grant +10 Resource at end of run.
16	**Nectar-Blood**	Treatable	Predators are attracted from a larger radius.	Reviving this scout takes 50% less time.
17	**Bark-Ribs**	**Scar**	Cannot equip "Heavy Armor" (Chest slot).	Naturally resists 25% of all piercing damage.
18	**Willow-Spine**	**Scar**	-10% Melee damage (Reduced leverage).	+20% Evasion; ignores movement penalties from mud.
19	**Fungal Ear-Drum**	Treatable	20% Sound-detection radius reduction.	Immune to "Sonic" or "Screamer" enemy stuns.

20	**Creeping Ivy**	**Scar**	Weapon swap speed is 50% slower.	Ignores movement penalties from "Overgrowth" terrain.
21	**Root-Grip**	**Scar**	-25% Interaction speed with "Human" tech.	100% accuracy with "Organic/Plant" based weaponry.
22	**Screaming Pores**	Treatable	Increases the "Aggro" radius of all predators.	Emits a low-frequency hum that scares away small pests.
23	**Thorn-Crown**	**Scar**	Stress gains are 10% higher.	Predators that bite/attack this scout take return damage.
24	**Succulent Flesh**	Treatable	Takes 20% more damage from fire/heat.	Can go twice as long without needing Rations.
25	**Cactus-Hide**	**Scar**	Cannot be "Healed" by other scouts' items.	Reflects 15% of all melee damage back to the attacker.
26	**Dandelion-Hair**	**Scar**	Lowers "Ingenuity" (Scout feels "floaty").	**Movement Speed is increased by 15% in high-wind/storm s.**

27	**Nightshade-Touch**	Treatable	Healing items are 30% less effective on them.	Small chance to "Poison" enemies on hit.
28	**Amber-Crust**	**Scar**	Stamina-recovery takes longer to start.	Increases "Legacy Points" earned by this scout by 50%.
29	**Wasp-Nest Gall**	Treatable	Scout occasionally takes "Sting" damage.	Releases a swarm when hit that distracts enemies.
30	**Fossilized Heart**	**Scar**	Cannot gain "Morale" buffs from teammates.	Immune to "Panic" and "Fear" status effects.

Bond table

#	Bond Name	The Buff (When Close)	The "Heartbreak" (If Bonded Partner Dies)
1	**Battle-Hardened**	+10% Precision for both scouts.	Survivor gains permanent "Cold-Blooded" trait (Reduced Morale).
2	**Lifeline**	Reviving this specific partner is 50% faster.	Survivor enters a "Catatonic" state for 2 missions.

3	**Scavenger Duo**	+20% Resource yield when harvesting together.	Survivor loses 10% Scavenging efficiency forever.
4	**Corporate Rivals**	+15% XP gain (Trying to outdo each other).	Survivor gains a "Vindictive" Stress buff (Damage up).
5	**Shared Trauma**	-15% Stress gain while in the same Chunk.	Survivor gains the "Paranoid" Double-Edged trait.
6	**Protector/Ward**	Protector takes 15% less damage; Ward gains +10 Resolve.	Protector enters a "Berserk" rage for the rest of the mission.
7	**Technical Synergy**	Repairing Ancient Constructs is 30% faster.	All "Tech" interactions now cause Stress for the survivor.
8	**The Old Guard**	Both scouts ignore movement penalties from mud/overgrowth.	Survivor loses 20 Max HP (Will to live drops).
9	**Optimistic Outlook**	Healing items used on each other are 25% more effective.	Survivor gains "Cynical" trait (Resolve drops).
10	**Cover-Fire Pair**	+20% reload speed when standing within 3 meters.	Survivor's Precision is halved for 3 missions.

11	**Spore-Tolerant**	Both scouts ignore the "Cough" penalty of Spore-Lung.	Survivor becomes "Spore-Addict" (Injury Scar).
12	**Recon Partners**	Fog-of-war reveal radius is increased by 15% for both.	Survivor's Awareness radius is permanently reduced.
13	**Echoes of Earth**	Morale regenerates slowly while resting at Camp.	Survivor gains the "Grieving" debuff (Speed down).
14	**Blood-Bound**	If one takes damage, the other gains +10% Damage for 5s.	Survivor takes 2x Stress from all sources.
15	**The Last Resort**	50% chance to "Dodge" a hit that would be fatal.	Survivor cannot be "Bonded" again for the rest of the game.

Bond Type	Acquisition	The Buff (When Close)	The "Heartbreak" (If Partner Dies)
Lovers	Surviving 5 missions together + 1 shared "Rest" event.	**Unbreakable:** Both scouts share a Morale pool. If one gains Morale, both do.	**Grief-Stricken:** Survivor loses 50% Resolve and has a 25% chance to "Refuse Deploy" for 5 missions.

#	Bond Name	The Buff	Narrative Hook

14	**Lovers**	Shared Morale & +10% Resolve.	"I'm coming home because you're there."
15	**Mentor/Protégé**	Veteran grants +25% XP to the Junior scout.	"Watch the vines, kid. They move when you blink."
16	**Blood Siblings**	Can swap inventory items instantly across any distance in a Chunk.	"I knew you'd need that extra battery."

Example character

Identity Category	Generated Data	Narrative/Mechanical Context
First Name	**Sloane**	(Western/Anglo Pool)
Surname	**Nwosu**	(African/Middle Eastern Pool)
Callsign	*"Lech"*	(Short for 'Lecherous'—scavenges everything)
History (Debt)	**Bio-Tech Dropout**	Owed for "stolen proprietary enzymes." (**+ING / +PRC**).

HP = 50 + (STR X 3) + (END X 2)

Core Stats (Lvl 1 Recruit)

Sloane is smart and precise, but her body is starting to fail her from years of "off-books" lab work.

- **END (Endurance):** 07 (Low - gets winded easily)
- **PRC (Precision):** 16 **(High)** (Knows exactly where to cut)
- **ING (Ingenuity):** 15 **(High)** (Can rewire a drone with a paperclip)
- **AWR (Awareness):** 10 (Average)
- **RES (Resolve):** 12 (Stable)
- **STR (Strength):** 08 (Low - not a pack mule)

Trait DNA (The Specialist Roll)

Sloane has one Positive and one Double-Edged trait.

- **Positive: Botany Savant**
    - *The Pro:* Can harvest "Hazardous" plants without taking damage.
    - *Utility:* Essential for getting rare toxins that other scouts would die trying to reach.
- **Double-Edged: Hoarder**
    - *The Pro:* Can carry +1 Heavy Item (Ancient Scrap) without the usual heavy penalty.
    - *The Con:* Consumes 2x Rations to "maintain strength"; refuses to drop loot once picked up.